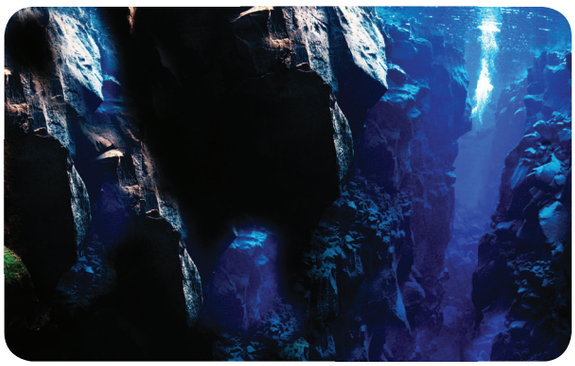


Figure 3.7 Silfra rift, Tingvellir, Iceland

Web link for Silfra drift

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=U3eT0qmPJbw

3.5 Plate boundaries

Plate boundaries are the zones where two or more plates move about. Plate tectonics describes the distribution and motion of the plates. The earth's surface is composed of rigid lithospheric slabs technically called "plates". The word **tectonic** is derived from the Greek word ***tekton*** meaning builders.

DO YOU KNOW?

Gnss (Global Navigation Satellite System) measures the speed of plate movement. Rate of seafloor spreading ranges from 1 to 2 centimetres per year along the oceanic ridge in the northern Atlantic Ocean to more than 15 cm per year along the East Pacific Rise.

Lithospheric plates are sometimes called as crustal plates or tectonic plates. Earth's lithosphere is divided into a series of major and minor mobile plates. Eurasian plate, Indo-Australian plate, North American plate, South American plate, Pacific plate, African plate and Antarctic plate are the major plates. Arabian plate, Caribbean plate, Cocas plate and Scotia plate are the examples of minor plates. Plates move at the rate of 2 to 3 centimeters per year.

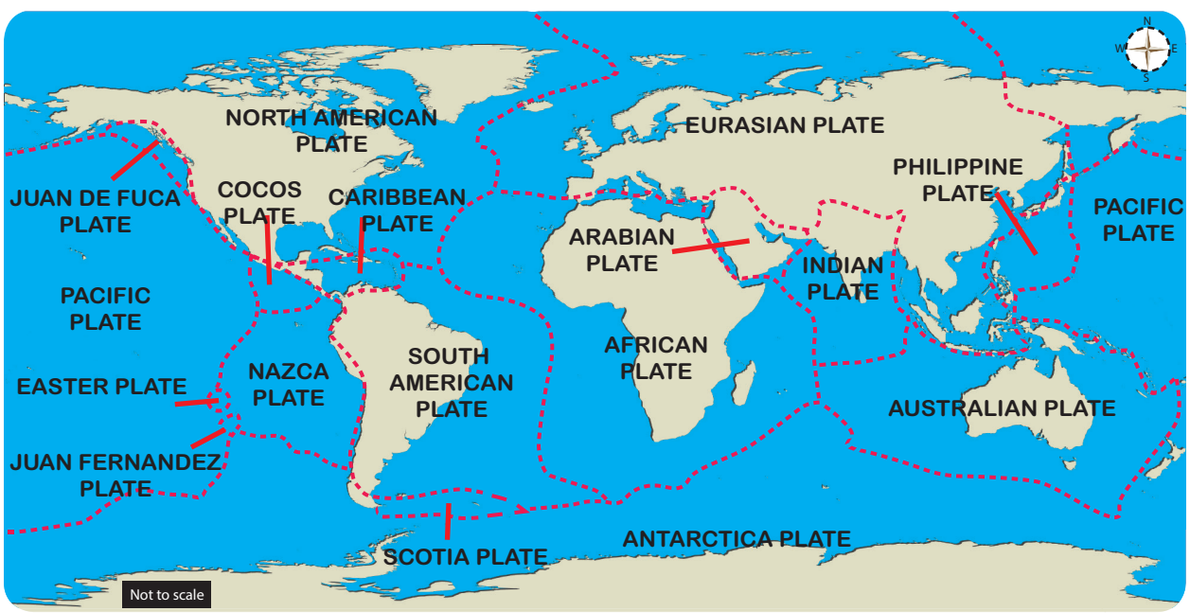


Figure 3.8 Distribution of tectonic plates

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